



THE VILLAGE OF SARANAC LAKE

LOCAL WATERFRONT REVITALIZATION PROGRAM



June 2002

the LA group



- Stabilize the shoreline embankments as needed.
- Develop an on-site parking lot adjacent to the courts.
- Provide picnic tables.
- A small fishing platform with handicapped access.

Lake Colby

Wallace Memorial Park

- Develop a four-season plan that includes year-round restrooms. Use guidelines for various winter events such as ice-fishing, ice skating, ATV and snowmobile races.
- Provide new sand on the beach and in the immediate swimming area.
- Address the point and nonpoint stormwater runoff problems through a mitigation plan.
- Develop a strategy to address the long-term control of non-native aquatic vegetation in the swimming area at the beach.

Land on Moir Road

- Tear down the existing building on the Village-owned property adjacent to Wallace Memorial Park. Construct a large picnic pavilion in its place with a deck that provides handicapped fishing access.
- Dedicate an area for a launch site for canoes and kayaks.

Walkways to the Beach

- Address safety issues and enhance the sidewalk and trail from the Village to Lake Colby and Lake Flower.
- Provide a more visible pedestrian crossing from the hospital to the Village's Wallace Park.

Saranac River

- Plans for development are under the direction of the River Corridor Commission. Their plan is available in the Office of Community Development.

in the area. Tourism is a highly competitive industry in the North Country. Places that have good infrastructure, good access to both passive and active recreational opportunities, access to food and drink, and shopping opportunities, have the best chance of attracting not only tourists, but also retaining existing residents and attracting new residents to the Village.

Lake Colby

There is an opportunity to increase public access at Lake Colby on Village-owned property adjacent to the existing park and beach. These lands are ideal for providing a picnic shelter, handicapped-fishing access and a canoe-launching site. None of these resources exist presently and would be a complimentary future asset to the resources in William J. Wallace Park.

Economic development in the Village of Saranac Lake must successfully package a blend the best of the Village's cultural, historic, and recreation resources for the best chance of new business creation and the retention of existing businesses.

Providing new and existing opportunities for access and activity along waterfront resources is an essential component for success. There is a strong physical and economic relationship between business and people in communities like Saranac Lake which have compact attractive lively downtown business districts and truly spectacular recreational and scenic resources. Each support one another and drive the community forward. There is an additional factor relating to the quality of life for residents. Good jobs sustain a stable year-round population. Strong year-round employment balanced with a strong tourism component can make the Saranac Lake way of life sustainable indefinitely.

The Village has an opportunity through this LWRP to create an attractive waterfront with unique elements that connect parks, trails and other resources to the Economic Center in the community.

Environmental Quality Review (SEQR) process provides an additional means whereby the local community can assess all potential significant environmental impacts of a proposed development. Local, state and federal review of major actions proposed in the Lake Flower and Saranac River and Lake Colby waterfront areas shall take into account the economic, social and environmental interests of Village residents.

Locate future development where public infrastructure capacity exists, where existing facilities can adequately handle the development, or where private facilities could be developed in such a way that community character, environmental quality, open space and natural resources are preserved and water-dependent uses are not displaced. There are presently no known restrictions or special concerns regarding the capacity of municipal water and sewer services to meet the demand from additional development. Cumulative adverse environmental impacts will also be considered and minimized during the review process.

1.5 *Protect stable residential areas.*

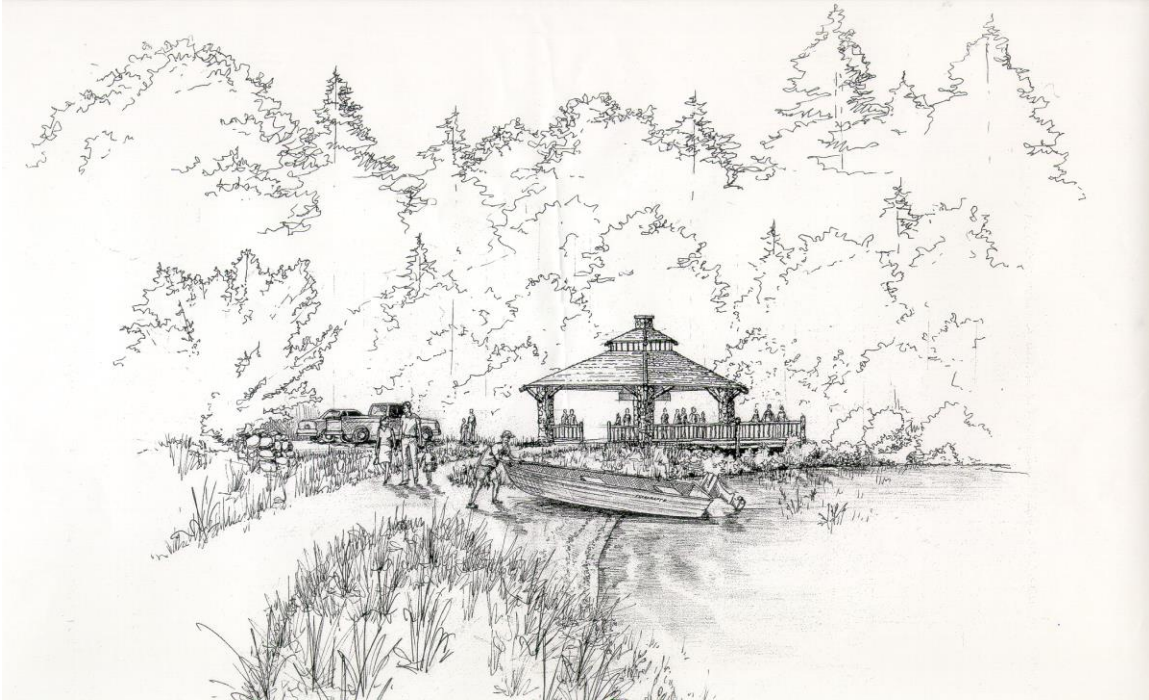
Residential land uses in Saranac Lake basically take two forms: detached single-family homes and multiple dwelling units occurring in multi-story buildings. Residences in and around the waterfront contribute to the vibrancy of the area by providing living accommodations close to the river, thus encouraging human contact and interaction with the waterfront. Specific policies for protection of residential areas are as follows:

- Maintain residential areas and allow for the restoration of existing commercial and institutional buildings for conversion to residential dwellings. In protecting the existing residential areas, the existing housing stock should be preserved and opportunities provided for the development of a variety of housing types to meet the needs of people at various stages of the life cycle, various income and age levels, and household compositions.
- Avoid new uses and developments, which are incompatible with existing residential development. New uses in a stable residential area will be avoided when the use, its design, or its scale will significantly impair the character or functionality of the neighborhood.
- Provide for zoning practices that will allow the residential use of space on upper floors and over commercial uses on lower floors of buildings in the downtown business district adjacent to the Saranac River.
- Develop a suitable environment for the development of retirement homes and seasonal visitor accommodations that add to the cosmopolitan environment of the community.

B. Economic Development Policies

Policy 2.0 Protect water-dependent uses and promote the siting of new water-dependent uses in suitable locations.

**Figure IV-3
Lake Colby Pavilion Rendering**



b. Lake Colby

Lake Colby has an established history of public use in the community over the past 35 years or so. While there are some good features in the park, there are a number of opportunities available that will greatly enhance the park and bring a greater level of use.

- Construct a large picnic pavilion on Village-owned property adjacent to the beach on the south shore. The pavilion can be rented by groups and families for special events or used by the Village for the same. On-site parking is already build-into the site along the existing stone wall.
- Provide handicapped-fishing access from the deck at the proposed new pavilion.
- Designate a formal launch site for canoes and kayaks at the pavilion site.
- Secure permits in order to provide the best solution to improve the sand retention and quality in the swimming zone.
- Plant trees to provide necessary shade, highway buffer and wind break where feasible, particularly in the parking area and the north end of the bathhouse.
- Expand the green space area and improve the overall attractiveness of the park by considering reclaiming some of the existing parking lot.

- Develop a four-season plan that includes year-round restrooms and guidelines for various winter events such as ice skating, ice-fishing, ATV or snowmobile races.
- Expand recreational programming to provide some kind of youth and family programs. Possibilities include regulation volleyball, tennis backboard, bocce ball, and construction of a new jungle gym.
- Allow commercial vendors to rent kayaks, canoes, rowboats, and small sailboats at the beach to provide access to the water.
- Enhance the sidewalk and trail to the beach from the Village and light the area with historic period lamps.
- Build up the area of the trail that drops below the elevation of the road so that there is better visibility. Extend the walkway from the Village of Saranac Lake and connected to this site and to the beach as well.
- Provide a trail connection from the Village beach area to the Town of Harrietstown Park and the Lake Colby State Boat Launch.

Estimated Total Project Cost:	\$325,000
Pavilion	\$ 125,000
Beach	\$ 75,000
Recreation	\$ 125,000

2. Other Community Needs

a. Signage

There is a great need for the Village to provide consistent and reliable signage to indicate public access to waterfront locations, public parking areas and the downtown Business District, and other recreational choices (alternatives). The recommendation is to develop an overall Sign Plan for the Village so that pedestrian and vehicular signage is coordinated, consistent, and reflects the Village's aesthetic goals. This plan should also address attractive signage at all gateways into the community. Any signage plan should consider addressing all-season activities.

Estimated Project Cost:	\$ 75,000
Planning	\$ 15,000
Implementation	\$ 60,000

b. Traffic

Traffic along River Street is a major concern for the community. This area is where pedestrians make the important link between the downtown business district and the waterfront. The highway as it presently exists is unsafe for pedestrians to cross at any location other than at the light at the intersection of River and Main Streets, and River and Church Streets. The width of River Street is out of scale with the village setting and does not promote interaction between Lake Flower waterfront resources and the business district, which is a primary goal of this LWRP. It is recommended in this report that a number of traffic calming alternatives be investigated by DOT and that DOT consider the